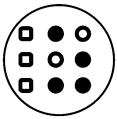
My Toolbox

Eight tools for starting a problem

AGES 6-8

1 Spot the pattern

Look for what repeats or grows.



2 List every way

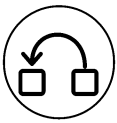
Write each way down, in order, so none is missed.

3 Draw it

Draw a picture or a bar of what the story says.

4 Make a table

Put what you know in rows and columns.

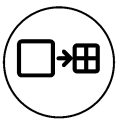


5 Work backwards

Start at the end and undo each step.

6 Guess and check

Pick a number, test it, then try a better one.



7 Try something simpler

Try it with smaller numbers first.

8 Act it out

Use counters, paper or people to show it.

Look back

Look at one problem from today

AGES 6-8

Pick one problem from today. There are no right answers. You can pass. Nobody reads it out.

1 **Did I answer the question?**

☐ yes ☐ not yet

2 **Does my answer make sense?**

☐ yes ☐ not yet

3 **Can I check it another way?**

Draw or write one word

My tool today

My name _____

☐ I am still stuck (my tutor will come) ☐ pass